



**CAL POLY**  
Mechanical Engineering  
COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

# Cal Poly ME Graduate Program 2026 Update



<https://ericwadelab.github.io/pages/GradInfo.2026.UG.pdf>

- ➊ Why YOU should get a graduate degree in ME
- ➋ Admissions process and timeline
- ➌ Degree requirements
- ➍ Your questions

# A graduate degree in ME

## Advantages

- Specialization: R&D, academia, innovation
- Additional skillset
- Salary (\$7-\$10K initial)

## Disadvantages

- Finances (temporary)
- Time

# Application process and timeline

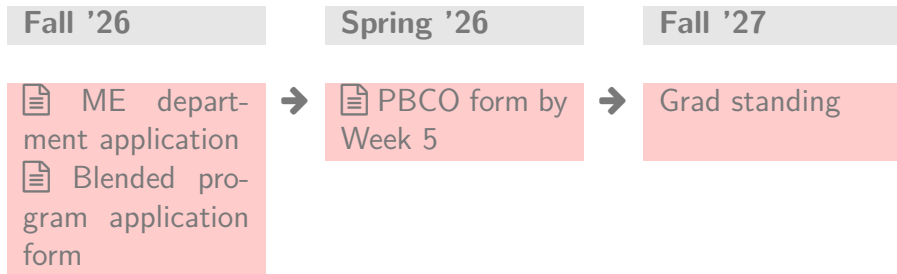
## BMS application

- **Deadline: Nov. 16, 2026**
- Required documents:
  - Personal statement
  - Transcripts (automatic)
  - List of three referees

## Review process

- GPA ( $>3.0$ )
- Ability to succeed in our program (transcript, statement, letters)

# Application process and timeline



# MS in ME degree requirements

| Description                | # Courses |
|----------------------------|-----------|
| ME Core classes            | 2         |
| ME technical electives     | 2         |
| Culminating experience     | 2         |
| Math requirement           | 1         |
| Technical electives (CENG) | 3         |
| <b>Total:</b>              | 10        |

<https://catalog.calpoly.edu/engineering/mechanical/mechanical-engineering-ms/>

# Some considerations (course option)

## Culminating experience

- Select three courses (5000-level)
- Exams to be completed within 1 week
- Exams graded by instructors; must pass 66%

# Some considerations (thesis option)

## Culminating experience

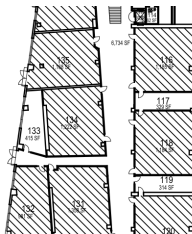
- Thesis defense
- Advisor + two committee members

## Finding an advisor

- Grad seminar
- Your instructors
- Faculty webpages
- Ask me

# Facilities and resources

- Graduate Student Lab (192-133) (work space, meetings)



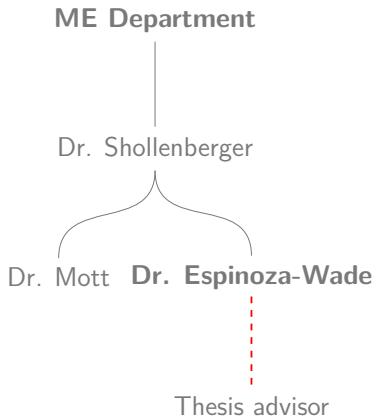
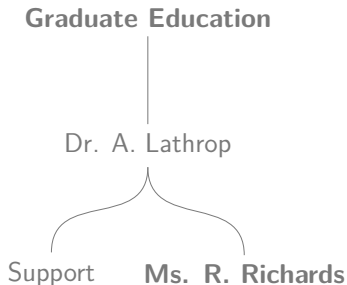
- Kennedy Library (printing, etc.)
- Room reservations (Building 13) [me-dept@calpoly.edu](mailto:me-dept@calpoly.edu)

# Funding opportunities

- Grading (\$18/hr), lab sections
- Tuition waivers (research assistants, employees, etc., Due June)
- Fellowships (\$5K, \$15K)
- Other opportunities may become available

<https://grad.calpoly.edu/financial-opportunities/graduate-research-award>

## Further questions (?)



## **Other questions/comments**

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